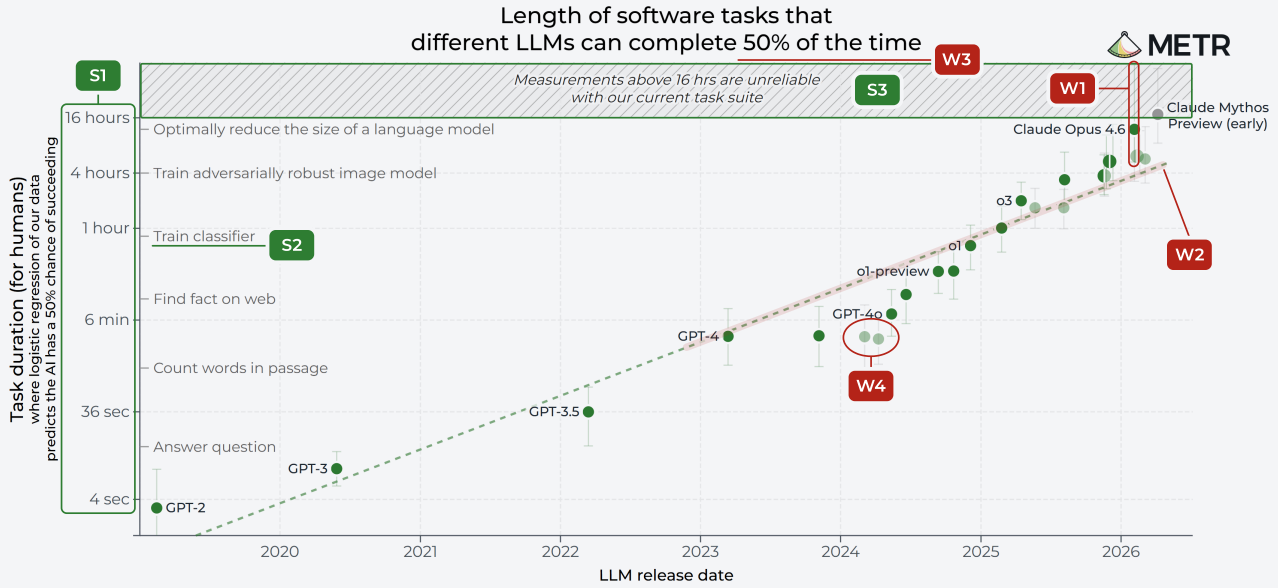
# METR's Time Horizon Chart Is Easy to Read, and Easy to Overread

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Original chart | Dataset | METR analysis code




*METR, Time Horizon 1.1, 50% success, log scale. Our additions:* S strength W weakness

## Strengths

**S1 Log scale makes doubling a straight line**
Steady growth reads as a steady slope, through position on a common scale, the most accurate channel (L4). Ratios also fit Weber's law (L4).

**S2 Example tasks give the axis meaning**
"Train classifier" at about an hour turns minutes into kinds of work, a conceptual unit (data models, L2).

**S3 It marks where its data stops**
Hatching and the gray Mythos dot pop out preattentively (L4), so the chart claims nothing its tasks cannot measure (expressiveness, L2).

## Weaknesses

**W1 Uncertainty is drawn at 20% opacity**
Opus 4.6 reads as 12 h, yet its 95% CI spans 5 to 61 h. Faint whiskers sink into the ground (L5). **Fix:** solid CI bars.

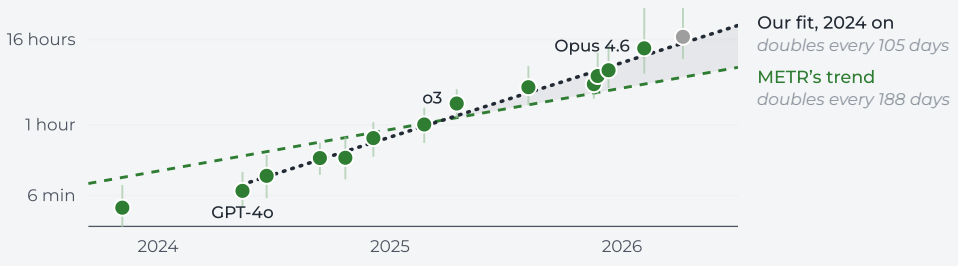
**W2 One straight line hides a bend**
Every frontier model since o3 sits above METR's line. Continuity (L5) reads it as one pace. **Fix:** add the recent fit.

**W3 "50%" carries the headline**
At 80% success Opus 4.6 drops from 12 h to 70 min, yet the threshold sits only in the title and a rotated label (L4). **Fix:** plot both.

**W4 Light and split dots go unexplained**
No key for light green, 10 of 26 models named, two models share one split dot (expressiveness, L2). **Fix:** key and jitter.

## Our reanalysis

Since o3, every frontier model sits **above** METR's line. A fit from 2024 on doubles every **105 days** (METR: 188).




## Marks

| | |
|---|---|
| Point | one AI model (26 in all) |
| Vertical line | 95% bootstrap CI |
| Dashed line | METR's exponential fit |
| Hatched area | above 16 h |
| Aa Text | model and task names |

## Channels

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| x position | release date | Q interval |
| y position, log | 50% horizon (human min) | Q ratio |
| Whisker length | width of the CI | Q ratio |
| Luminance | frontier at release or not | N |
| Gray hue, texture | beyond the 16 h ceiling | N |